



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

satyaṃ vāhanaśastrāṇi gobījarajatāni ca | 20.002a
devatāpitṛpādās ca dattāni sukṛtāni ca || 2 || 20.002c
mahāparādhe divyāni dāpayet tu mahīpatiḥ | 20.003a
alpeṣu ca naraḥ śreṣṭhaḥ śapathaiḥ śāpayen naram || 3 || 20.003c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 20, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The text speaks of invoking sacred objects or concepts – truth itself, vehicles, weapons, cows, seeds, silver, deities, the feet of ancestors, charitable deeds – as part of an ordeal. These weren't simply physical tests, but deeply spiritual appeals to cosmic justice. The idea was that a guilty person would be unable to utter a false oath or withstand the ordeal without divine intervention revealing their deceit. The king, representing dharma, would employ divya or ordeals in grave matters, while respected individuals could administer oaths in lesser disputes.

Think of it less as a literal endorsement of antiquated practices and more as a profound statement about integrity. In our modern world, we might not subject someone to an ordeal involving fire or water, but the underlying principle remains relevant. The passage emphasizes the weight of truth and the consequences of falsehood. When you make a promise, are you honoring the sacredness of your word? When you engage in a business transaction, are you upholding ethical principles? The 'ordeal' today might be the scrutiny of your peers, the judgment of the market, or the quiet burden of a guilty conscience.

The essence of this verse is about cultivating inner integrity. Each time you choose truth over expediency, honesty over deception, you're participating in a modern-day 'ordeal' where your character is tested. The sacred objects mentioned – truth, ancestors, charitable acts – represent the values we should hold dear. They are reminders of the interconnectedness of actions and consequences, both seen and unseen. By aligning your actions with these values, you invite harmony and integrity into your life. Ultimately, this passage encourages you to reflect on your own moral compass and how you navigate the challenges of truth and deception in your daily life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you consciously incorporate the spirit of truth and integrity into your daily interactions, making each choice a reflection of your highest self?